ServiceNow

Announcement — Scenario 1

Communicating updates to employees

Scenario:

- A general message should be visible to all users
- Another message should target only IT users
- Some announcements should automatically expire after a few days
- Multiple announcements should be visible to different audiences

Announcement — Scenario 2

Diagnosing announcement problems

An announcement was created, but:

❌ **Not visible**

Some users cannot see the announcement

❌ **Never expires**

Announcement never disappears

❌ **Wrong place**

Appears in the wrong location

Students should analyze:

- How visibility settings control who sees announcements
- How roles determine audience targeting
- How duration/expiry fields affect when announcements disappear

👉 **How do visibility, roles, and duration affect announcements?**

sc_request — Scenario 1

User submits a service request from the catalog

Scenario:

- The request is created in the system
- It may be submitted for another user (on behalf of)
- Users need to track only their own requests
- Managers should be able to view all requests

Determine how requests are stored, tracked, and filtered.

sc_request — Scenario 2

Issues appearing in the request system

❌ Wrong visibility

Users can see requests that are not theirs

❌ State confusion

Changing state affects processing unexpectedly

Also note:

- Some requests contain multiple items that need to be tracked separately

- How visibility is controlled per user and role
- How request state changes affect downstream behavior

sc_req_item (RITM) — Scenario 1

A single request includes multiple requested items

Scenario:

- Each item represents a specific service or product
- Each item can be assigned to different teams
- Additional details (variables) are required per item

How items are structured and managed under a request.

sc_req_item (RITM) — Scenario 2

Implementing item logic and automation

The system requires:

- Automatic assignment of items to the correct team or user
- Controlled visibility — users should only see relevant items
- Ability to handle multiple items under one parent request

sc_task — Scenario 1

Each requested item generates tasks

Scenario:

- Tasks are assigned to users or groups
- Tasks move through different states (Open → In Progress → Closed)
- Tasks must be completed before the parent request is fulfilled

sc_task — Scenario 2

Problems occurring in task management

❌ **Unauthorized edits**

Unauthorized users can edit tasks

❌ **Incomplete tasks**

Some tasks are not being completed

Also note:

- Confusion between request items (RITMs) and tasks — roles and responsibilities unclear

Students should analyze:

- How to restrict write access to assigned users only
- How task lifecycle and state impact the overall request process

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👉 **How do you restrict access and manage task lifecycle impact?**

End-to-End Scenario

Full service request lifecycle

Process Flow:

- 1. User submits request
- 2. Request contains multiple items
- 3. Each item generates tasks
- 4. Tasks are assigned and completed

Common Issues:

- Missing tasks — not generated
- Incorrect assignments
- Delays in processing

Students should:

- Track relationships between records (Request → RITM → Task)
- Identify where the process may fail
- Suggest improvements to the workflow

👉 **How will you track and troubleshoot the full request lifecycle?**

ACL — Scenario 1

Securing access across the system

The company wants to enforce:

- Users should only see their own requests
- Different roles should have different permissions
- Sensitive fields should be hidden from certain users
- Some records should not be editable after completion

ACL — Scenario 2

After applying security rules — unexpected results

❌ **Too little access**

Some users cannot access records they should

❌ **Too much access**

Others have more access than expected

Students should analyze:

- How ACL rules are evaluated — order and priority
- The role of conditions and scripts in access control
- How to debug conflicting or misconfigured ACL rules

👉 **How is access control evaluated? What role do conditions and scripts play?**

Debugging — Scenario

Users report access issues — configuration appears correct

❌ **Request issue**

"I cannot see my request"

❌ **Task issue**

"I cannot update my task"

The configuration seems correct — but something is blocking access.

Students should:

- Investigate the issue — check ACL rules, roles, and conditions
- Identify the blocking rule causing the restriction
- Fix the problem and verify the resolution

👉 **How will you investigate, identify, and fix the blocking rule?**

Practice

Announcement Scenario

Scenario:

- A new menu is available starting today
- Only waiters should see a special internal note
- The announcement should disappear automatically after a few days
- Another message should be visible only to chefs

👉 **How will you configure announcements to meet these requirements?**

Scenario:

- The order is submitted by a waiter
- Sometimes the waiter orders on behalf of a customer
- Each waiter should only see their own orders
- Managers can see all orders
- The system should track all created requests

👉 **How will you manage request visibility and tracking?**

Scenario:

- One customer order may include: Pizza, Drink, Dessert
- Each item needs to be handled separately
- Can be assigned to different staff
- May require additional details (size, extras)

👉 **How will you structure items under a single request and manage assignments?**

Scenario:

- A task should be assigned to the chef when an item is created
- Chef updates task status: Preparing → Ready
- Only the assigned chef can modify the task
- If the task is not completed, the order is delayed

👉 **How will you control task assignment, updates, and completion?**

Scenario:

- 1. Staff receives announcement
- 2. Waiter creates order
- 3. Order contains multiple items
- 4. Each item generates tasks
- 5. Chef completes tasks → Order is delivered
- Issues: Task not completed · Wrong assignment · Missing data

👉 **How will you track and troubleshoot the full lifecycle?**

Scenario:

- Waiters → see only their own orders
- Chefs → see tasks only
- Managers → full access
- Total Amount → visible only to managers
- Closed orders → cannot be edited

👉 **How will you enforce these security rules?**

Debugging Scenario

❌ **Waiter Issue**

"I can't see my orders"

❌ **Chef Issue**

"Chef cannot update task"

System seems correct, but access is blocked.

Investigate:

- Check ACL rules — are they active and correctly scoped?
- Verify user roles and group memberships
- Review assignment logic — is the correct user/group set?
- Check conditions on business rules or workflows

👉 **How will you identify and fix the root cause of each access issue?**

Here are **practice questions** (with answers) covering **ServiceNow CSA/CAD-style topics** you mentioned: *Service Portal*, *Announcements*, *Widgets*, *Catalog Builder (standard)*, *and Record Producer*. These are useful for certification prep and interview practice.

- **Service Portal Questions**

1. What is the Service Portal in ServiceNow?

Answer:
A customizable front-end framework that allows users to interact with ServiceNow through a web interface using widgets, pages, and themes.

2. What are the main components of a Service Portal?

Answer:

Pages
Widgets
Themes
Menus
Blocks (containers)

3. What is a Widget in Service Portal?

Answer:

A reusable component that combines:

HTML

CSS

Client Script

Server Script

4. Where are Service Portal widgets stored?
Answer:
In the **Widget table (sp_widget)**

5. What scripting languages are used in widgets?
Answer:
Server-side: JavaScript (Glide API)
Client-side: AngularJS

- **Announcements Questions**

6. What are Announcements in ServiceNow?
Answer:
Messages displayed to users in the portal to communicate updates, alerts, or important info.

7. Where can announcements be displayed?
Answer:
Service Portal
Platform UI

8. What controls the visibility of an announcement?

Answer:

User roles

Start & end date

Conditions

9. Can announcements be targeted to specific users?
Answer:
Yes, using roles and conditions.

- **Widgets Questions**

10. What are the main parts of a widget?
Answer:
HTML Template
CSS
Client Script
Server Script
Link function (optional)

11. What is the role of the Server Script in a widget?
Answer:
Handles backend logic and retrieves data from the database.

12. What is the role of the Client Script?
Answer:
Handles UI interaction and dynamic behavior.

13. What AngularJS concept is used in widgets?
Answer:
Controllers and $scope

14. How do widgets communicate with the server?

Answer:

Using server.get() or server.update()

- **Catalog Builder (Standard) Questions**

15. What is Catalog Builder?
Answer:
A guided tool to create and manage catalog items without deep scripting.

16. What can you create using Catalog Builder?
Answer:
Catalog Items
Record Producers
Order Guides

17. What is a Catalog Item?
Answer:
A requestable item in the Service Catalog (e.g., laptop request).

18. What are variables in Catalog Builder?
Answer:
Fields used to collect user input (e.g., text, choice, reference).

19. Can you add flows to catalog items?
Answer:
Yes, using Flow Designer.

- **Record Producer Questions**

20. What is a Record Producer?
Answer:
A catalog item used to create records in a specific table.

21. How is a Record Producer different from a Catalog Item?

Answer:

Record Producer → creates a record directly

Catalog Item → creates a request (REQ/RITM)

22. What is the purpose of the script field in a Record Producer?

Answer:

To manipulate data before record creation.

23. Can Record Producers be used in Service Portal?
Answer:
Yes.

24. What table stores Record Producers?

Answer:

sc_cat_item_producer

24. What table stores Record Producers?

Answer:

sc_cat_item_producer

Choice

. Which table stores widgets?

A. sp_page

B. sp_widget

C. sc_cat_item

D. sys_ui_page

Answer: B

Which component is used to create records directly?

A. Catalog Item

B. Widget

C. Record Producer

D. Announcement

Answer: C

What framework does Service Portal use?

A. React

B. AngularJS

C. Vue

D. jQuery

Answer: B

What defines the layout of a Service Portal page?

A. Widget

B. Theme

C. Container

D. Record Producer

Answer: C

Which table stores Service Portal pages?

A. sp_widget

B. sys_ui_page

C. sc_cat_item

D. sp_page

Answer: D

What is a Theme in Service Portal?

A. A styling framework for branding
B. A script
C. A database table
D. A widget type

Answer: A

Which API is commonly used in Service Portal server scripts?

A. GlideSystem

B. GlideRecord

C. AngularJS

D. UI Policy

Answer: B

Which part of a widget handles user interaction?

A. Server Script
B. HTML Template
C. Client Script
D. CSS

Answer: C

Which of the following is NOT part of a widget?

A. HTML

B. CSS

C. Flow Designer

D. Server Script

Answer: C

What is the purpose of the link function in widgets?

A. Database connection

B. Security control

C. Server query

D. DOM manipulation

Answer: D

What determines when an announcement is visible?

A. Start and End date

B. Table name

C. Script include

D. Widget

Answer: A

How can announcements be restricted?

A. By roles
B. By database table
C. By CSS
D. By API

Answer: A

Where can announcements appear?

A. Only backend

B. Only Service Portal

C. Both platform UI and portal

D. Only mobile

Answer: C

Catalog Builder is designed for:

A. Developers only

B. Non-technical users

C. Database admins

D. Security teams

Answer: B

Which tool is used to automate catalog workflows?

A. UI Builder

B. Report Builder

C. Script Editor

D. Flow Designer

Answer: D

What is created when a Record Producer is submitted?

A. RITM
B. REQ
C. Record in a table
D. Widget

Answer: C

Which table stores Record Producers?

A. sc_cat_item
B. sc_cat_item_producer
C. sp_widget
D. sys_user

Answer: B

Record Producers are part of:

A. Service Catalog
B. Service Portal only
C. CMDB
D. Reports

Answer: A

Thank you